

Paul Sentongo

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Professional Summary

Results-driven Data Scientist with 4+ years of experience specializing in predictive analytics and growth hacking. Led the development of a churn-prediction and acquisition suite that directly grew the customer base by 18%. Deeply passionate about leveraging data for social good and mentoring to foster a data-driven organizational culture.

Technical Skills

- Programming Languages: Python, R, SQL.
- Frameworks: Scikit-learn, Pandas, Numpy, Matplotlib, Docker
- Databases: MySQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB
- Tools: Excel, Power BI, PowerPoint.
- Version Control: Git, GitHub.
- Platforms: VS Code, Google colab, Jupyter notebook.

Work Experience

Data Scientist | Absa Bank Uganda

April 2025 – Present

- Developed and applied predictive models and advanced analytics including customer churn risk modeling and fraud detection that grew the customer base by 18% and protected returns by deploying fraud detection model that reduced fraudulent transactions in payments by 30
- Conducted deep exploratory data analysis (EDA) and root-cause investigations on SLA breaches and service delays using trend analysis where insights informed operational redesigns that contributed to a 22% reduction in turnaround time (TAT).
- Communicated complex analytical findings to senior stakeholders through concise dashboards, reports, and presentations, translating model outputs and performance metrics into clear business narratives and actionable recommendations.
- Designed and delivered end-to-end data science and analytics solutions supporting Retail and Business Banking operations, combining statistical analysis, machine learning, and performance analytics to drive operational efficiency and digital adoption.

Operations Business & Performance Analyst | Absa Bank Uganda

Aug 2024 – April 2025

- Implemented automated data pipelines for KPI and MI reporting, integrating multiple operational data sources; reduced manual reporting effort by 35% and established a governed single source of truth for operational performance.
- Built executive-level performance dashboards tracking productivity, turnaround times, SLA compliance, digital vs manual processing and improved bank operations productivity levels by 30%.
- Reduced Operations systems downtime by 20% by building a web application that monitored downtime and triggered alerts.
- Drove root-cause analysis on SLA breaches and queue times, enabling interventions that improved processing time by 22%.
- Partnered with 10 operations teams to intake analytics and automation requests, translating problem statements into data-driven solutions that improved staff welfare resulting from increased automation levels of 65%.

Branch Manager | Absa Bank Uganda

Jan 2024 – Aug 2024

- Led branch compliance and audit readiness; achieved a clean audit with 0 high-risk findings.
- Led a team of 12 staff to grow sales by 18% and increased deposit growth by 12%.
- Standardized cash-ops controls and coaching, reducing cash-variance incidents by 40%.

Education and Certifications

Uganda Christian University, Master of Science in Data Science and Analytics October 2025

- Completed a thesis on: "Machine Learning for Accurate Valuation of Imported Items In Uganda Customs", graduating with High Distinction and a focus on scalable predictive modeling and Big Data Analytics.

Uganda Christian University, Bachelor of Business Computing October 2014

- Graduated with Honors with bias in Business analytics and Data Warehousing

Projects

Import Valuation / Price Prediction App Price prediction App

- Built and deployed an ML web app to estimate import prices/valuation, improving decision accuracy by **95%** vs. manual lookup.
- **Tech:** Python, Streamlit, BERT (Transformers), Pandas, Matplotlib, CSS.

Population Forecasting Model Population Prediction App

- Predicted Canada's population trends (competition task) using a regression pipeline with careful feature engineering and cross-validation.
- Delivered an interactive Streamlit app for scenario analysis, what-if inputs, and dynamic visualization of projections.
- **Frameworks:** Python, Streamlit, Scikit-learn, Pandas, Power BI, Matplotlib.

Affiliations

Ambassador: World Ethical Data Foundation <https://worldethicaldata.org/projects/ambassadorship>

Languages

- English (Fluent).